USC REC F- 35– Protocol Review Assessment Form

ASSESSMENT POINTS		Which section of your research protocol?
1. SCIENTIFIC VALIDITY		
1.01.	Is/Are the main research question(s) reasonable?	Statement of the Problem / Research Question
1.02.	Are the study objectives specific, measurable, attainable, and reasonable based on the research instrument(s) presented?	Chapter 3: Methodology Appendixes (attached instruments)
1.03.	Is/Are the research instrument(s)/data collection tool(s) adopted from existing one(s) and has the developer's consent for its usage in the study?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Research Instrument - Research Procedure Appendix: - attached full research instrument/s - attached screenshot of Google Forms, if it is done online - Screenshot of the email asking permission from the author of the research instrument
1.04.	Does the protocol present sufficient background information or results of previous studies that merit the involvement of human participants?	Review of Related Literature

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ASSESSMENT POINTS		Which section of your research protocol?
2. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY		
2.01.	In conducting this research, is there no conflict of interest on the part of the researchers and/or their Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s)?	Appendix: CVs of researchers and research adviser - Certificate of no conflict of interest
2.02.	For faculty-initiated research only: Is there disclosure of collaborative study terms of reference (e.g. multi-country/ multi-institutional studies, including intellectual property rights, publication rights, information and responsibility in sharing, transparency and capacity building)?	Appendix (if applicable)
2.03.	Is/Are the researcher(s) sufficiently knowledgeable/ trained to conduct the proposed study based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?	Appendix: CV of researchers
2.04.	Do(es) the Research Adviser(s)/Supervisor(s)/Mentor(s) has/have sufficient research experience based on his/her/their dated and signed CV?	Appendix: CV of research adviser

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2. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY		
2.05.	Is the research environment/site/facility appropriate?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Research Site/Environment
2.06.	Does the selection and recruitment of participants comply with the ethical demands of equity?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Research respondents/participants - Research procedure Appendix - transmittal letter (if applicable) - call for participants (poster/online post, if applicable)
2.07.	Is the duration of human participants' involvement in the study reasonable?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Research procedure
2.08.	Does the study involve individuals who are vulnerable, i.e. those whose pertinent circumstances will likely impair their capacity to give free, prior and informed consent?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Research respondents

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2. ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN THE CONDUCT OF STUDY		
2.09.	Are appropriate mechanisms in place to protect the potential vulnerable participants, e.g. assent form for children?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Ethical considerations Appendix: ICF/assent forms are attached
2.10.	Are probable risks/harm to the human participants as result of participation in the study clearly identified, i.e. physical, psychological, social, economic, legal?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Ethical considerations
2.11.	In order to adequately address the risk/benefit balance, does the protocol provide means/mechanisms that sufficiently mitigate the risks/probable harm to the human participants?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Ethical considerations
2.12.	Is the informed consent procedure/form adequate and culturally appropriate, e.g. (back-) translation is appended? Indicate “NA” if not applicable.	Appendix: - ICF/assent form - questionnaire/scale, interview guide

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ASSESSMENT POINTS		Which section of your research protocol?
3. DATA PROTECTION PLAN		
3.01.	Does the study involve personal/sensitive data collection and/or processing?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan Appendix: - questionnaire or interview guide
3.02.	Does the protocol provide measures for personal/sensitive information to be sufficiently anonymized for adequate data protection?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan
3.03.	Is there legal permission to obtain and process the data? Indicate “NA” if not applicable.	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan Appendix: - permission letter addressed to specific institution (if applicable)
3.04	Does the study specify how long will collected data be used/processed?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan

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ASSESSMENT POINTS		Which section of your research protocol?
3. DATA PROTECTION PLAN		
3.05.	Does the protocol provide measures as to how data transfer/sharing information will be monitored?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan
3.06.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of data structure/format or encryption of identifiable information and separation from sensitive data such as health data?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan
3.07.	Does the study discuss how and where collected data will be securely stored in terms of treating unforeseen data added such as incidental findings during the study?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan
3.08.	Does the study discuss where collected data will be securely stored in terms of location and hardware, e.g. avoids loss/easily accessible media such as memory sticks?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan

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ASSESSMENT POINTS		Which section of your research protocol?
3. DATA PROTECTION PLAN		
3.09.	Does the protocol indicate how collected data will be securely accessed?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan
3.10.	Does the study clearly state how and when collected data will be (ir)reversibly disposed/destroyed?	Chapter 3: Methodology - Data management plan

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